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May 6, 1980
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. W-L-314A
October 5, 1955

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

LIGHTS; HOUSEHOLD

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers incandescent lights for general household use with a 2 pole, 3 wire, parallel blade grounding type plug.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types. Lights covered by this specification shall be of the following types and styles designated by slash sheet numbers:

Types:

VIII - Dresser Light, 100 watts.
IX - Dressing table Light, 100 watts.
XIII - Large floor Light, with harp, 50/100/150 watts.
XV - Large table Light, with harp, 50/100/150 watts.
XVI - Tall table Light, with harp, 50/100/150 watts.
XVII - Extra tall table Light, with harp, 50/100/150 watts.
XVIII - Junior floor Light, with harp, 50/100/150 watts.
XIX - Swing-arm floor Light, with harp, 50/100/150 watts.
XX - Small table Light, with harp, (study), 50/100/150 watts.
XXI - Small table Light, swing-arm, (study), with harp, 50/100/150 watts.

Styles:

A - Conventional design.
B - Modern design.
C - Colonial design.
D - Provincial design.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal specifications, standards, and commercial item descriptions, as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specification, Standards, and Commercial Item Descriptions. The Index, which includes cumulative bimonthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification, other Federal Specifications, and Commercial Item Descriptions required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston; New York; Philadelphia; Washington, DC; Atlanta; Chicago; Kansas City, MO; Fort Worth; Huston; Denver; San Francisco; Los Angeles; and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal specifications, standards, commercial item descriptions, and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Commercial Item Descriptions from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

Underwriter's Laboratories (UL), Inc. Standards:

No. 153 - Portable Electric Lamps.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Underwriter's Laboratories, Inc., 207 East Ohio Street, Chicago, IL 60611; 1285 Walt Whitman Road, Melville, Long Island, NY 11746; or 1655 Scott Blvd., Santa Clara, CA 95050.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Fire and casualty hazards.

3.1.1 Each contractor shall submit to the contracting officer proof that lights proposed under this specification conform to requirements of UL Standard No. 153. A label or listing mark of the UL shall be accepted as evidence of such conformance.

3.1.2 In lieu of the label or listing mark, the contractor shall submit independent proof, satisfactory to the contracting officer, that lights conform to the applicable requirements of the published standards including methods of tests of UL Standard No. 153.

3.2 Material. The material used in the construction of lights and shades shall not warp or flex to such an extent as to affect the appearance. Materials such as wood shall be suitably treated and finished to reduce warping tendencies to a minimum.

3.3 Component parts. Each light shall be furnished complete with shade as specified herein. Types VIII and IX shall have either a clip-on shade or a harp supporting a shade. All the other types shall have a harp large enough to accommodate a 150/50-R/W lamp.

3.4 Dimensions. The dimensions shall be in accordance with the individual slash sheets. Illustrations contained therein are meant to be descriptive of the types specified in 1.2.1 and are not restrictive to lamps of any one manufacturer.

3.5 Tolerances. A plus or minus tolerance of one inch is permitted.

3.6 Construction. The light and shade shall be well constructed and sufficiently sturdy to withstand, without damage, the application of any force or stress to which it is likely to be subjected to in service. The various parts shall be centered by check rings, seatings, or other suitable means. The Light, when placed on a level plane, shall have the shaft perpendicular to that plane with a tolerance of ± 0.500 inch at a height 48 inches. The rim of the shade shall be parallel to the plane within ± 1 degree. Finials shall be held in position by a threaded stud. The component parts of the light shall be rigidly locked together by means of lock washers, jam nuts, or other effective means before placing the socket and harp on the assembly. A brass shell, medium base socket with set screw, shall be used to lock the harp in place.

3.7 Attachment and assembly. No equipment shall be attached to the glass parts of the light bulb. No metal parts shall be closer than 1/8-inch to the light bulb glass, except that "clip-on" shades may be furnished for types VIII and IX.

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3.8 Finish.

3.8.1 Metal parts. Corrodible materials shall be covered with a suitable protective coating. The finish of all exposed metal parts shall not be capable of being removed after being subjected for 24 hours to the humidity test specified in 4.4.2.

3.8.2 Wood parts. All wood used in lamps shall be kiln dried. The wood shall be from clear cuttings; free from defects such as knots, checks, splits, decays, or seasoning defects. The wood shall be finished as follows:

Filler, if required.
One coat of penetrating stain, if required.
One coat of sealer.
Two coats of finish.

3.9 Lampholders. Lampholders shall be constructed so that current carrying parts of the lamp base are not exposed when the lamp bulb is in place. Each medium screw base lampholder shall not turn when subjected to a torque of 25 pound-inches.

3.10 Shade. The shade shall be self-centering and when in position on the light shall hang evenly. All material shall be of such texture and density that it will prevent the bulbs and light fixtures from being seen through the shade when lighted. There shall be reasonable freedom from shadows from the parts or lamps when any or all light sources are in operation. All textile materials and trimmings shall be securely attached to the frame.

3.11 Shade construction. The shade shall be of sturdy construction. The frame shall be covered with a protective coating. The shade shall show no sign of distortion or other damage and the supportive members shall not loosen, buckle, or separate, when tested as specified in 4.4.1 and 4.4.2. All frame fitters shall be of sufficient thickness to securely hold the top wires. Thin flat washers are not acceptable.

3.12 Flexible cord and plug. A flexible cord with a minimum length of 7 feet shall be measured from the point at which the cord emerges from the light to the face of the attachment plug.

3.13 Recovered materials. The contractor shall utilize recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable.

3.14 Drawings. A drawing of the household light shall be furnished the General Services Administration. The drawing shall show descriptive and detailed information such as materials, dimensions, identity of components such as sockets, shades, etc. when these are manufactured by others and used in the assembly of the product. The drawing shall be furnished in reproducible form and copies will be made available by the General Services Administration to Government agencies ordering against Federal Supply Schedule contracts for use in the inspection of deliveries.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein.

4.2 Sampling for acceptance inspection. Sampling for acceptance inspection shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

4.3 Visual and dimensional. Lights and shades shall be examined for visual defects and for compliance with this specification as to type, material, finish, and other requirements that can be measured by visual examination. Measurements shall be made to determine compliance with the dimensions shown on the slash sheets. Conformity with the manufacturer's drawings shall also be verified.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Shade distortion. The shade shall be placed on a flat horizontal surface and a weight of 25 pounds evenly distributed over the top. After 5 minutes the shade frame shall be examined for distortion (see 3.11).

4.4.2 Humidity test. The shade and metal parts shall be exposed for a period of 24 hours in an atmosphere of not less than 85 percent relative humidity at a temperature of 85° ± (29.4° ± 3°C). The shade shall bear a weight of 10 pounds that is evenly distributed on the supporting member (see 3.8.1 and 3.11).

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4.5 Inspection of preparation for delivery. An inspection shall be made to determine compliance with the requirements in section 5. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table I. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers offered for acceptance at one time. The inspection level shall be S-4 with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE I. Classification of defects

Examine	Defects
Marking	Omitted, incorrect, and illegible.
Materials	Packaging materials not as specified, missing, damaged, or non-serviceable.
Workmanship	Containers inadequately closed and secured, poor application of internal packaging and packing material, and distorted intermediate packages.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. The household light of one type, shall be cushioned and packaged individually. The boxes shall be secured to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.2 Commerical. Household lights, one type only shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with normal commercial practice. The complete package shall be designed to protect the item against damage during shipment, handling, and storage.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A or commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Household lights packaged as specified in 5.1.1 shall be packed in corrugated fiberboard boxes made from weatherproof fiberboard with a bursting strength of not less than 275 pounds per square inch. The box flaps shall be secured with water resistant adhesive applied to the entire area of contact between the flaps or with a 3 inch wide water resistant tape applied to the full length of the center seams and extending over the ends not less than 3 inches. Alternatively, wirebound cleated plywood or nailed wood boxes shall be acceptable shipping containers when lined with a waterproof barrier material. The barrier material shall be sealed at the edges with waterproof tape or adhesive.

5.2.2 Commercial. Household lights packaged as specified in 5.1.2 shall be packed in fiberboard boxes to insure safe delivery at destination, to provide for safe redistribution by the initial receiving activity, and shall be acceptable by common carrier under National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification.

5.3 Marking. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1) marking shall be in accordance with 5.3.1, 5.3.2, and 5.3.3.

5.3.1 Unit packages. Each unit package shall be plainly marked to indicate the name of the article, light type, and the quantity contained inside.

5.3.2 Shipping container. Each shipping container shall be marked in the upper right corner on one side panel and one end panel with the following, arranged in the order shown:

(a) National Stock Number.
(b) Specification sheet No., type, style, and item name.
(c) Quantity inside.
(d) Contractors name and address (and manufacturer's name and address, if different).
(e) Contract and purchase or delivery order number.
(f) Gross weight and cubic displacement (to the nearest 0.1 cubic foot).

5.3.3 In addition, shipping containers shall be marked with appropriate exterior caution markings.

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5.4 Unitization. When shipment to Government depots are full car or truckload, the shipping containers shall be unitized to facilitate handling in accordance with commercial practice. The unitized load shall not exceed 2,500 pounds in weight, 63 inches in height, 56 inches in length, and 45 inches in width.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. This specification covers incandescent household lights for general household use such as officers quarters, nurses' homes, reception rooms, etc. The application of the different types is self-explanatory.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Specification sheet No., type, and style (see 1.2.1).
(c) Responsibility for inspection, if other than specified (see 4.1).
(d) Level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(e) Special marking, if required (see 5.3).

Military Interest:

DSA-GS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY:

GSA-FSS

Preparing Activity:

GSA-FSS

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein.

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